

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 20

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to recognize Ralph J. Schulz, Jr., on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, Ralph Schulz is one such estimable person, who, after eighteen years of devoted service as chief executive officer and president of the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce, will take his much-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Schulz was named chief executive officer (CEO) and president of the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce in 2006 following a thirty-year career in nonprofit management, marketing, and fundraising; and

WHEREAS, as president and CEO of the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce, Ralph Schulz took on essential leadership roles at one of Middle Tennessee's oldest and largest business federations; and

WHEREAS, during his fruitful career with the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce, Mr. Schulz played a key part in helping the region emerge from the 2007 recession and transitioning to a period of unprecedented growth, following a business relocation and expansion strategy known as Partnership 2020; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce was a critical part of creating the nationally recognized Nashville Entrepreneur Center and passing a public referendum to support construction of the Music City Center convention facility, as well as leading the movement to improve public school performance with the Academies of Nashville; and

WHEREAS, the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce was named "Chamber of the Year" by the American Chamber of Commerce Executives (ACCE) in 2009, a most befitting honor that recognizes the Chamber's organizational excellence, service to its members, development of its leaders and volunteers, and its impact on key community priorities; and

WHEREAS, the ACCE award referenced the Chamber's role in creating Nashville for All of Us, a campaign consisting of community leaders who aligned to defeat a 2009 charter referendum, which would have prohibited the Nashville city government from conducting business in a language other than English; the Chamber was also praised for "A Leading Edge," a broad range of programs aimed at helping Chamber members navigate the hardships of the recession; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Schulz began his career in the nonprofit industry in 1974 with Junior Achievement (JA) of Nashville; he ultimately spent twenty years with JA, leading chapters in Jackson, Mississippi; Dallas, Texas; and New York, New York; and

WHEREAS, in 1990, Ralph Schulz was named the national executive vice president for Junior Achievement, in which position he operated from the organization's headquarters in Colorado Springs, Colorado; he returned to Nashville in 1996 and accepted a similar national role with the National Federation of Independent Business; and

WHEREAS, Ralph Schulz went on to serve the Adventure Science Center as CEO for six years, during which time he helped the team focus on turning an aging, science-based nonprofit organization into a leading destination for young people, with growing attendance, revamped exhibits, successful capital campaigns, and stronger community support. In 2001, the Science Center was duly recognized by the Center for Nonprofit Management with the Marvin Runyon Leadership Award for its turnaround efforts; and

WHEREAS, Ralph Schulz is a graduate of the University of Tennessee and has served a number of civic and nonprofit boards, including the Nashville Health Care Council, the Center

for Nonprofit Management, Alignment Nashville, and the Tennessee Business Roundtable, among several others; and

WHEREAS, he has been involved with the Transit Alliance of Middle Tennessee and the NashvilleNEXT Steering Committee, and he served as a member of the Citizens Advisory Committee for Bus Rapid Transit; he currently serves as a member of the MTA Strategic Plan Advisory Committee; and

WHEREAS, his professional accomplishments aside, Mr. Schulz is most grateful for the love and support of his wife, Leeanne, their four children, and six grandchildren, and during his retirement, he will, hopefully, find the time to hang more Christmas lights at home; and

WHEREAS, since 2006, Mr. Schulz has played a critical role in the vitality and life of this State, and he will leave behind an indelible legacy of service and success; and

WHEREAS, throughout his exemplary tenure as chief executive officer and president of the Nashville Area Chamber of Commerce, Mr. Schulz has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and community alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend to Ralph J. Schulz, Jr., our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.